

# **PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT**

**FUTURE INTERNS –  
CYBER SECURITY  
INTERNSHIP**



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# INTRODUCTION & OBJECTIVES

- PHISHING IS ONE OF THE MOST COMMON AND DANGEROUS CYBER THREATS AFFECTING INDIVIDUALS AND ORGANIZATIONS WORLDWIDE.
- ATTACKERS USE FRAUDULENT EMAILS, FAKE WEBSITES, AND DECEPTIVE MESSAGES TO TRICK USERS INTO REVEALING SENSITIVE INFORMATION SUCH AS PASSWORDS, BANKING CREDENTIALS, PERSONAL DATA, AND ONE-TIME PASSWORDS (OTPS).
- THE PURPOSE OF THIS REPORT IS TO ANALYZE PHISHING EMAIL SAMPLES, IDENTIFY COMMON PHISHING INDICATORS, CLASSIFY EMAIL RISKS, AND PROVIDE PRACTICAL AWARENESS GUIDELINES TO HELP USERS RECOGNIZE AND AVOID PHISHING ATTACKS.

## OBJECTIVES:-

- ANALYZE PHISHING EMAIL SAMPLES
- IDENTIFY PHISHING INDICATORS AND WARNING SIGNS
- CLASSIFY EMAILS BASED ON RISK LEVEL
- UNDERSTAND HOW PHISHING ATTACKS WORK
- PROVIDE PREVENTION AND AWARENESS GUIDELINES
- IMPROVE CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS AMONG USERS

## TOOLS USED:-

| Tool          | Purpose               |
|---------------|-----------------------|
| Gmail         | Email Analysis        |
| MXToolbox     | Email Header Analysis |
| Browser Tools | URL Inspection        |
| Canva         | Report Design         |
| GitHub        | Project Documentation |

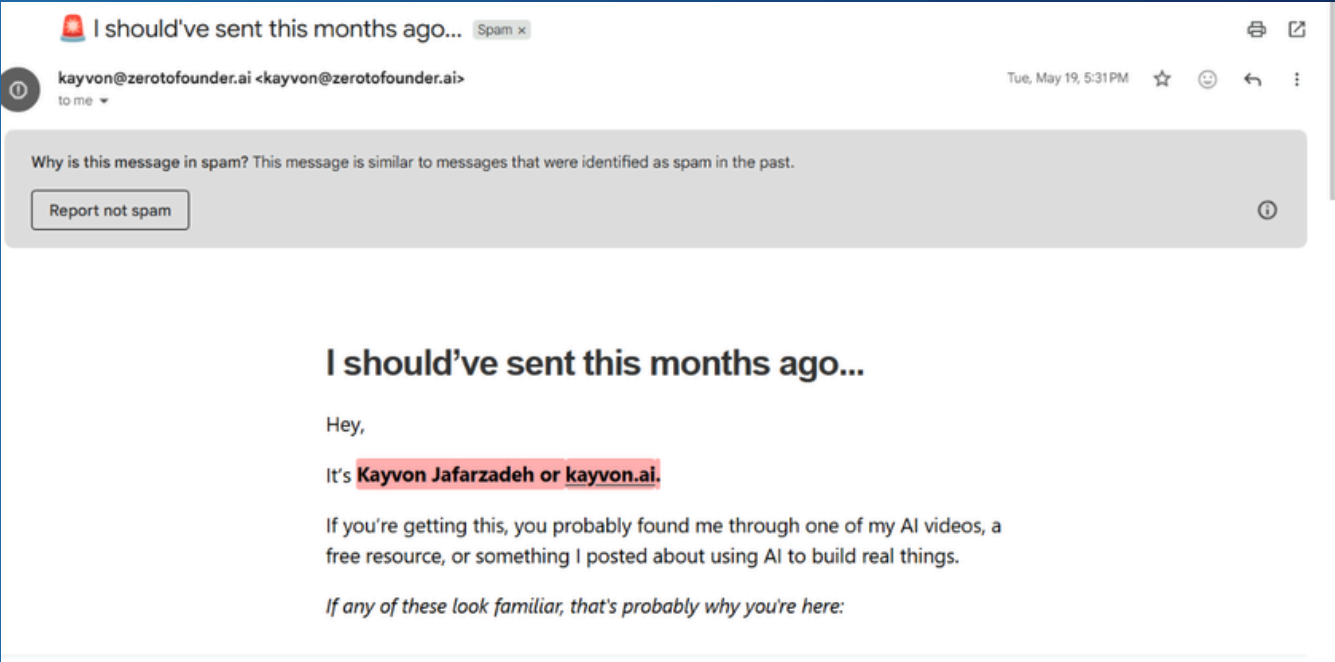
## ASSESSMENT SCOPE:-

ASSESSMENT TYPE:  
PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS

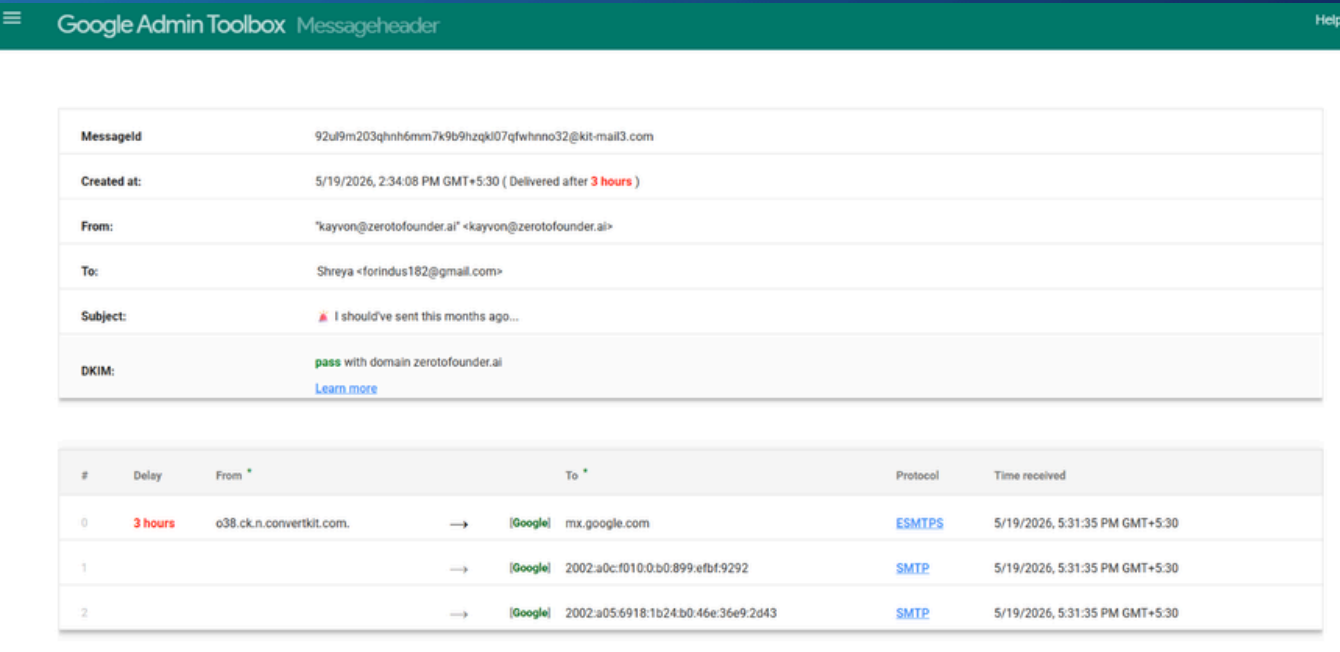
METHODOLOGY:  
EMAIL ANALYSIS, HEADER REVIEW, RISK CLASSIFICATION, AND SECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING

FOCUS:  
IDENTIFYING PHISHING INDICATORS AND EDUCATING USERS ON PHISHING PREVENTION.

EMAIL SAMPLE 1 (ZEROTOFOUNDER.AI) :-



GOOGAL ADMIN TOOLBOX:-



GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX ANALYSIS RESULT:-

THE EMAIL HEADER WAS ANALYZED USING GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX MESSAGE HEADER ANALYZER.

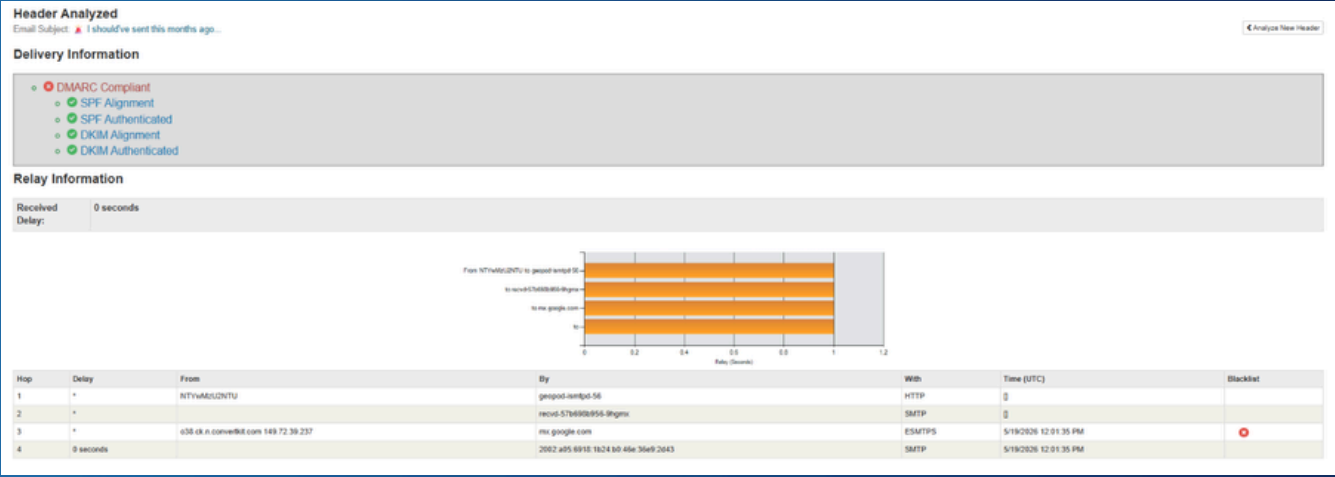
ANALYSIS RESULTS SHOWED THAT THE EMAIL SUCCESSFULLY PASSED DKIM AUTHENTICATION, INDICATING THAT THE MESSAGE WAS SENT FROM AN AUTHORIZED DOMAIN AND WAS NOT MODIFIED DURING TRANSMISSION.

THE DELIVERY PATH SHOWED NORMAL EMAIL ROUTING THROUGH GOOGLE'S MAIL INFRASTRUCTURE WITHOUT ANY UNUSUAL BEHAVIOR.

- RESULT:
- DKIM AUTHENTICATION: PASS
  - EMAIL ROUTING: SUCCESSFUL
  - DOMAIN VERIFICATION: VALID

CLASSIFICATION:  
SUSPICIOUS EMAIL (MEDIUM RISK)

# MXTOOLBOX TOOL:-



# MXTOOLBOX ANALYSIS RESULT:-

THE EMAIL HEADER WAS FURTHER ANALYZED USING MXTOOLBOX EMAIL HEADER ANALYZER.

THE ANALYSIS CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION. THESE RESULTS INDICATE THAT THE SENDER DOMAIN WAS PROPERLY AUTHENTICATED AND NO SPOOFING ATTEMPT WAS DETECTED.

- RESULT:
- **SPF: PASS**
  - **DKIM: PASS**
  - **DMARC: PASS**
  - **AUTHENTICATION STATUS: SUCCESSFUL**

# SUMMARY:-

BOTH GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX AND MXTOOLBOX CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL EMAIL AUTHENTICATION. ALTHOUGH THE EMAIL WAS DELIVERED TO THE SPAM FOLDER AND ORIGINATED FROM AN UNKNOWN SENDER, NO DIRECT SPOOFING OR AUTHENTICATION FAILURES WERE IDENTIFIED.

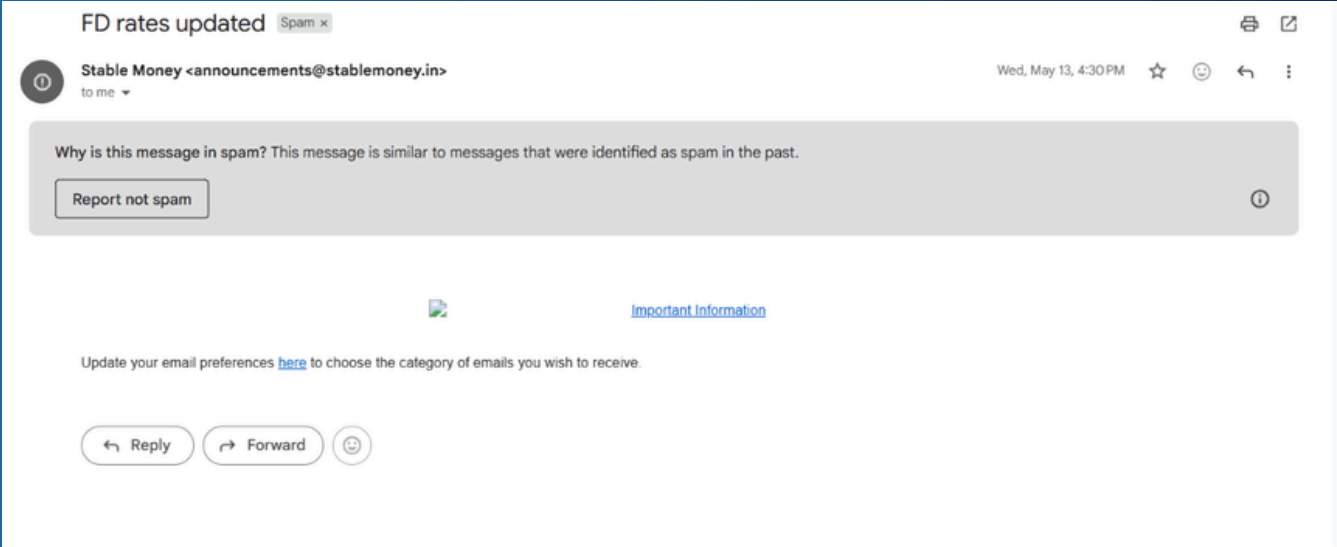
# EMAIL SAMPLE 2 (STABLEMONEY.IN):-

## EMAIL DETAILS:-

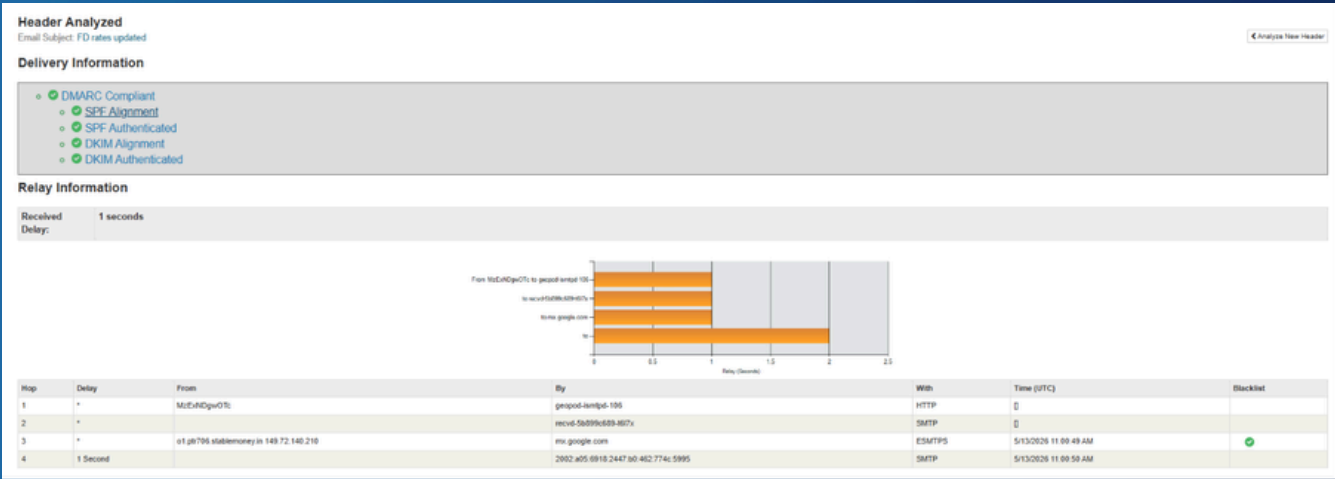
SUBJECT: FD RATES UPDATED

SENDER: ANNOUNCEMENTS@STABLEMONEY.IN

CATEGORY: FINANCIAL PROMOTIONAL EMAIL



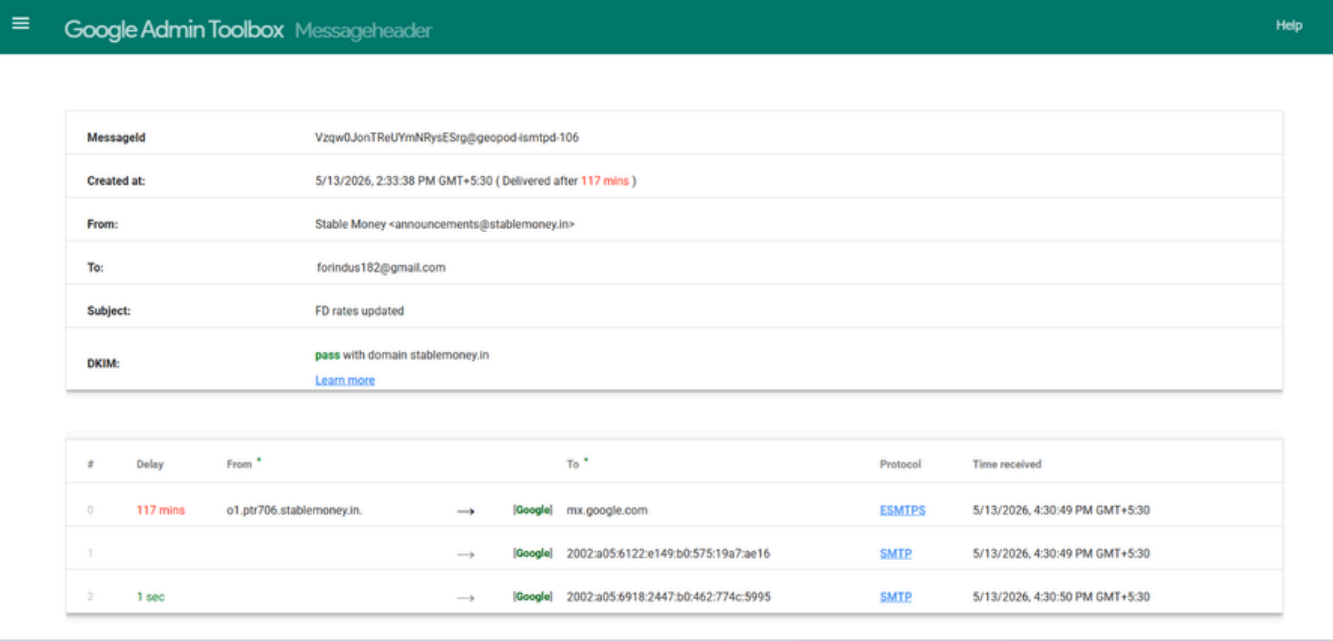
## MXTOOLBOX :-



## MXTOOLBOX ANALYSIS SUMMARY:-

- THE EMAIL HEADER WAS ANALYZED USING MXTOOLBOX EMAIL HEADER ANALYZER.
- THE RESULTS CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION. THE EMAIL ORIGINATED FROM AN AUTHORIZED SENDING DOMAIN AND NO SPOOFING ATTEMPT WAS DETECTED.
- MAIL ROUTING INFORMATION SHOWED NORMAL DELIVERY THROUGH GOOGLE'S MAIL INFRASTRUCTURE.

# GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX:-



# GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX ANALYSIS:-

- THE EMAIL HEADER WAS ANALYZED USING GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX MESSAGE HEADER ANALYZER.
- THE ANALYSIS CONFIRMED THAT THE EMAIL SUCCESSFULLY PASSED DKIM AUTHENTICATION USING THE STABLEMONEY.IN DOMAIN. THE DELIVERY PATH SHOWED NORMAL ROUTING THROUGH GOOGLE'S MAIL INFRASTRUCTURE WITHOUT ANY ABNORMAL BEHAVIOR.
- THE EMAIL WAS DELIVERED SUCCESSFULLY AND NO AUTHENTICATION FAILURES WERE DETECTED DURING TRANSMISSION.

# ANALYSIS RESULTS:-

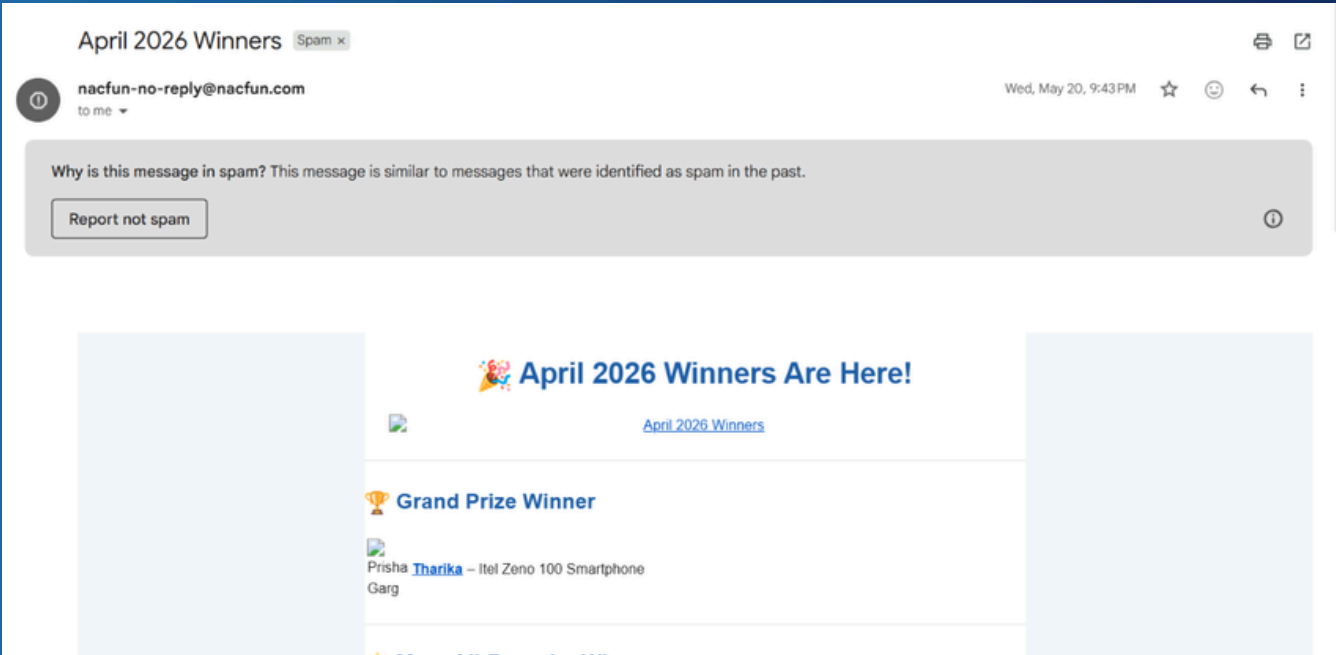
| Parameter       | Result         |
|-----------------|----------------|
| Sender Domain   | stablemoney.in |
| DKIM Status     | PASS           |
| Delivery Status | Successful     |
| Email Routing   | Normal         |
| Authentication  | Valid          |

# RISK ASSESSMENT:-

CLASSIFICATION: SUSPICIOUS EMAIL

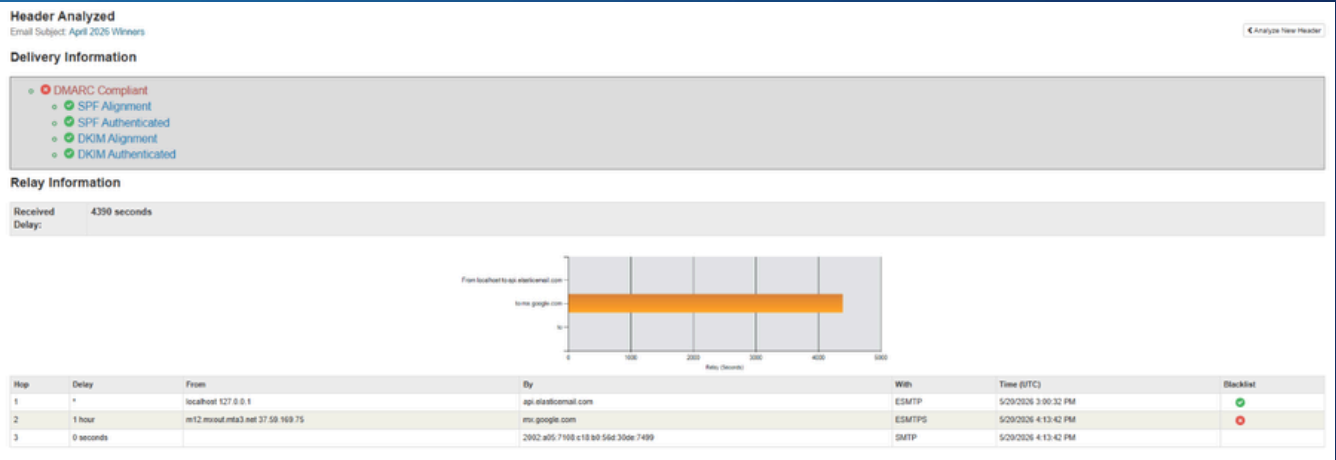
RISK LEVEL: MEDIUM

# EMAIL SAMPLE 3 (NACFUN-NO-REPLY@NACFUN.COM) :-



- **PRIZE / REWARD BASED LURE:** THE EMAIL ATTEMPTS TO ATTRACT USER ATTENTION BY ANNOUNCING PRIZE WINNERS AND REWARDS.
- **SPAM FOLDER CLASSIFICATION:** GMAIL AUTOMATICALLY CLASSIFIED THE MESSAGE AS SPAM, INDICATING SIMILARITY TO PREVIOUSLY REPORTED PROMOTIONAL OR POTENTIALLY DECEPTIVE CAMPAIGNS.
- **UNSOLICITED COMMUNICATION:** THE RECIPIENT DID NOT DIRECTLY REQUEST OR SUBSCRIBE TO THIS WINNER NOTIFICATION.
- **CLICK-DRIVEN ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY:** THE EMAIL ENCOURAGES RECIPIENTS TO INTERACT WITH LINKS AND WINNER ANNOUNCEMENTS TO INCREASE ENGAGEMENT.
- **UNKNOWN SENDER ORGANIZATION:** THE SENDER DOMAIN IS NOT WIDELY RECOGNIZED BY THE RECIPIENT AND MAY REDUCE TRUSTWORTHINESS.
- **PROMOTIONAL CAMPAIGN CHARACTERISTICS:** THE EMAIL PRIMARILY FOCUSES ON PRIZE ANNOUNCEMENTS AND MARKETING-STYLE ENGAGEMENT RATHER THAN ESSENTIAL ACCOUNT-RELATED COMMUNICATION.
- **AUTHENTICATION VERIFICATION REQUIRED:** HEADER ANALYSIS SHOULD BE PERFORMED TO VERIFY SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION STATUS BEFORE TRUSTING THE MESSAGE.

## MXTOOLBOX:-



## MXTOOLBOX ANALYSIS:-

THE EMAIL HEADER WAS ANALYZED USING MXTOOLBOX EMAIL HEADER ANALYZER.

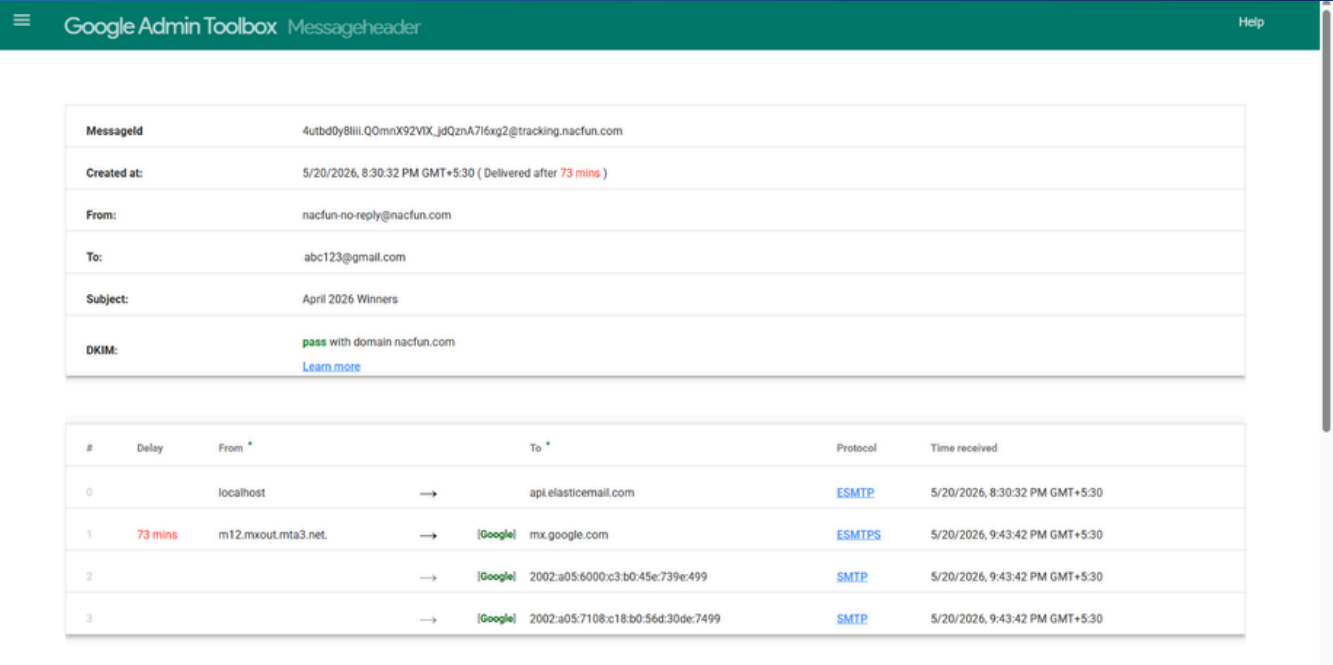
THE ANALYSIS CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION. NO SENDER SPOOFING INDICATORS OR AUTHENTICATION FAILURES WERE DETECTED.

MAIL ROUTING INFORMATION SHOWED NORMAL DELIVERY THROUGH GOOGLE'S MAIL INFRASTRUCTURE.

## RISK CLASSIFICATION:-

CLASSIFICATION: SUSPICIOUS EMAIL  
RISK LEVEL: MEDIUM

# GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX:-



# GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX ANALYSIS:-

- THE EMAIL HEADER WAS ANALYZED USING GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX MESSAGE HEADER ANALYZER.
- THE ANALYSIS CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL DKIM AUTHENTICATION FOR THE NACFUN.COM DOMAIN. EMAIL ROUTING RECORDS SHOWED SUCCESSFUL DELIVERY THROUGH GOOGLE'S MAIL INFRASTRUCTURE WITHOUT ANY AUTHENTICATION FAILURES.
- THE MESSAGE FOLLOWED A NORMAL DELIVERY PATH AND NO EVIDENCE OF EMAIL SPOOFING OR HEADER MANIPULATION WAS IDENTIFIED.

# ANALYSIS RESULTS:-

|                 |            |
|-----------------|------------|
| Parameter       | Result     |
| Sender Domain   | nacfun.com |
| DKIM Status     | PASS       |
| Delivery Status | Successful |
| Email Routing   | Normal     |
| Authentication  | Valid      |

**FINAL CLASSIFICATION :-**  
**CLASSIFICATION: SUSPICIOUS EMAIL**  
**RISK LEVEL: MEDIUM**

# CONCLUSION:-

- BOTH MXTOOLBOX AND GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX CONFIRMED SUCCESSFUL SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION FOR THE EMAIL.
- ALTHOUGH THE SENDER DOMAIN WAS AUTHENTICATED AND NO SPOOFING INDICATORS WERE DETECTED, THE EMAIL WAS DELIVERED TO THE SPAM FOLDER AND USED PRIZE-BASED PROMOTIONAL CONTENT TO ENCOURAGE USER INTERACTION.
- BASED ON THE ANALYSIS, THE MESSAGE IS CLASSIFIED AS A SUSPICIOUS EMAIL WITH MEDIUM RISK.

## HOW PHISHING ATTACKS WORK:-

**1.THE SETUP: ATTACKERS CREATE FRAUDULENT OR DECEPTIVE EMAIL CAMPAIGNS USING TRUSTED-LOOKING DOMAINS, MARKETING PLATFORMS, OR COMPROMISED INFRASTRUCTURE TO REACH A LARGE NUMBER OF USERS.**

**2.THE BAIT: THE ATTACKER CRAFTS ATTENTION-GRABBING MESSAGES USING FINANCIAL OFFERS, PRIZE ANNOUNCEMENTS, ACCOUNT ALERTS, OR URGENT NOTIFICATIONS DESIGNED TO TRIGGER CURIOSITY, EXCITEMENT, OR FEAR.**

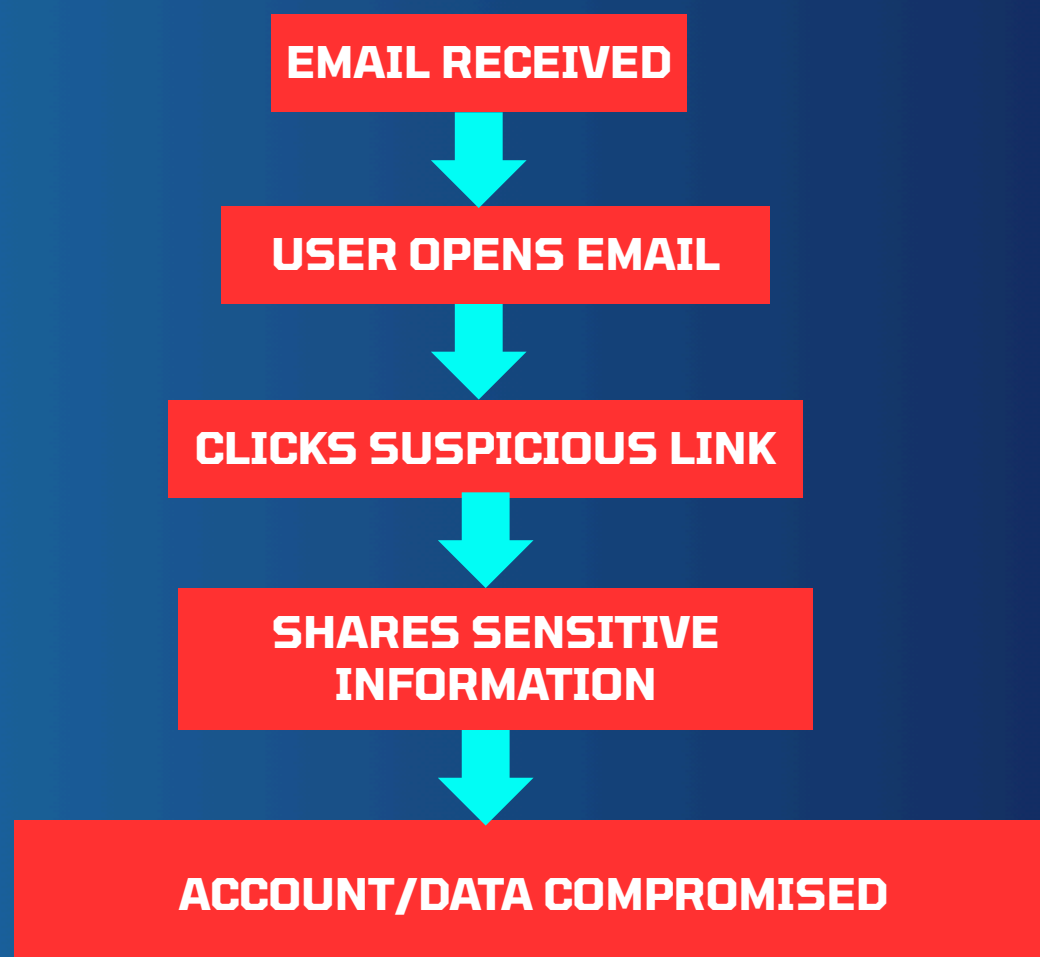
**3.THE TRAP: THE EMAIL ENCOURAGES THE RECIPIENT TO CLICK LINKS, OPEN ATTACHMENTS, VERIFY ACCOUNT DETAILS, CLAIM REWARDS, OR VISIT EXTERNAL WEBSITES THAT APPEAR LEGITIMATE.**

**4.THE EXPLOITATION: IF THE USER INTERACTS WITH THE MALICIOUS CONTENT, SENSITIVE INFORMATION SUCH AS USERNAMES, PASSWORDS, BANKING DETAILS, PERSONAL INFORMATION, OR AUTHENTICATION CODES MAY BE EXPOSED.**

**5.THE IMPACT: COMPROMISED INFORMATION CAN BE USED FOR IDENTITY THEFT, FINANCIAL FRAUD, UNAUTHORIZED ACCOUNT ACCESS, OR FURTHER PHISHING CAMPAIGNS TARGETING ADDITIONAL VICTIMS.**

## AWARENESS NOTE:-

**USERS SHOULD ALWAYS VERIFY THE SENDER, INSPECT LINKS CAREFULLY, AND AVOID SHARING SENSITIVE INFORMATION THROUGH EMAIL-BASED REQUESTS.**



# RISK SCORING & CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM:-

| Indicator Type                  | Sample 1 | Sample 2 | Sample 3 | Risk Points |
|---------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|-------------|
| Unknown / Unsolicited Sender    | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 2           |
| Delivered to Spam Folder        | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 2           |
| Promotional / Marketing Content | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 1           |
| User Interaction Encouraged     | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 1           |
| Generic Communication Style     | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 1           |
| SPF Authentication Passed       | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 0           |
| DKIM Authentication Passed      | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 0           |
| DMARC Authentication            | Yes      | Yes      | Yes      | 0           |

## TOTAL RISK SCORE:

SAMPLE 1 = 7 / 10

SAMPLE 2 = 7 / 10

SAMPLE 3 = 7 / 10

## RISK CLASSIFICATION: MEDIUM RISK (SUSPICIOUS EMAILS)

### RISK ASSESSMENT SUMMARY:-

- ALL THREE ANALYZED EMAILS WERE DELIVERED TO THE SPAM FOLDER AND CONTAINED UNSOLICITED PROMOTIONAL OR ENGAGEMENT-ORIENTED CONTENT.
- ALTHOUGH SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION CHECKS WERE SUCCESSFULLY PASSED, THE EMAILS ORIGINATED FROM UNKNOWN SENDERS AND ENCOURAGED USER INTERACTION.
- BASED ON THE OVERALL ASSESSMENT, ALL SAMPLES WERE CLASSIFIED AS SUSPICIOUS EMAILS WITH MEDIUM RISK.

# **PREVENTION GUIDELINES (USER SAFETY TIPS):-**

- **VERIFY THE SENDER'S EMAIL ADDRESS:**  
DO NOT TRUST ONLY THE DISPLAY NAME SHOWN IN THE EMAIL. ALWAYS CHECK THE ACTUAL SENDER EMAIL ADDRESS BEFORE RESPONDING OR CLICKING ANY LINKS.
- **HOVER BEFORE CLICKING:**  
BEFORE CLICKING ANY LINK, PLACE YOUR MOUSE POINTER OVER IT TO VIEW THE ACTUAL DESTINATION URL. AVOID CLICKING LINKS THAT LOOK SUSPICIOUS OR UNRELATED TO THE SENDER.
- **VISIT WEBSITES DIRECTLY:**  
IF AN EMAIL CLAIMS THERE IS AN ISSUE WITH YOUR ACCOUNT, DO NOT USE LINKS PROVIDED IN THE MESSAGE. OPEN YOUR BROWSER AND MANUALLY TYPE THE OFFICIAL WEBSITE ADDRESS.
- **BE CAUTIOUS OF URGENT REQUESTS:**  
PHISHING EMAILS OFTEN CREATE PANIC BY USING URGENT LANGUAGE SUCH AS "ACCOUNT SUSPENDED," "IMMEDIATE ACTION REQUIRED," OR "VERIFY NOW."
- **NEVER SHARE SENSITIVE INFORMATION:**  
LEGITIMATE ORGANIZATIONS WILL NEVER ASK FOR PASSWORDS, OTPS, BANKING PINS, OR SECURITY CODES THROUGH EMAIL.
- **CHECK FOR GRAMMAR AND FORMATTING ISSUES:**  
POOR GRAMMAR, SPELLING MISTAKES, UNUSUAL FORMATTING, AND GENERIC GREETINGS CAN BE INDICATORS OF PHISHING ATTEMPTS.
- **USE MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA):**  
ENABLE MFA WHEREVER POSSIBLE TO PROVIDE AN ADDITIONAL LAYER OF SECURITY EVEN IF CREDENTIALS ARE COMPROMISED.
- **REPORT SUSPICIOUS EMAILS:**  
IF YOU RECEIVE A SUSPICIOUS EMAIL, REPORT IT TO YOUR ORGANIZATION'S SECURITY TEAM OR MARK IT AS SPAM TO HELP PREVENT FUTURE ATTACKS.

# EMPLOYEE DO'S AND DON'TS:-

## DO:

- REPORT ANY SUSPICIOUS OR UNUSUAL EMAIL TO YOUR ORGANIZATION'S IT OR SECURITY TEAM IMMEDIATELY.
- VERIFY THE SENDER'S EMAIL ADDRESS BEFORE RESPONDING TO ANY REQUEST INVOLVING SENSITIVE INFORMATION.
- CHECK WHETHER FINANCIAL, BANKING, OR ACCOUNT-RELATED EMAILS ADDRESS YOU BY YOUR ACTUAL NAME RATHER THAN USING GENERIC GREETINGS SUCH AS "DEAR CUSTOMER" OR "DEAR USER".
- INSPECT LINKS CAREFULLY BEFORE CLICKING AND ENSURE THEY DIRECT TO LEGITIMATE WEBSITES.
- ENABLE MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA) WHEREVER AVAILABLE TO IMPROVE ACCOUNT SECURITY.
- DELETE UNSOLICITED EMAILS OFFERING UNEXPECTED REWARDS, LOANS, INVESTMENTS, OR FINANCIAL BENEFITS.

## DON'T:

- DO NOT CLICK LINKS OR DOWNLOAD ATTACHMENTS FROM UNKNOWN OR SUSPICIOUS SENDERS.
- DO NOT TRUST AN EMAIL SOLELY BECAUSE IT CONTAINS AN OFFICIAL LOGO, BRANDING, OR PROFESSIONAL DESIGN.
- DO NOT SHARE PASSWORDS, OTPS, BANKING DETAILS, OR PERSONAL INFORMATION THROUGH EMAIL.
- DO NOT CLICK THE "UNSUBSCRIBE" OPTION IN CLEARLY SUSPICIOUS OR PHISHING EMAILS, AS IT MAY CONFIRM THAT YOUR EMAIL ACCOUNT IS ACTIVE.
- DO NOT RESPOND TO EMAILS THAT CREATE URGENCY, PRESSURE, OR FEAR TO FORCE IMMEDIATE ACTION.
- DO NOT ENTER LOGIN CREDENTIALS ON WEBSITES ACCESSED THROUGH UNSOLICITED EMAIL LINKS.

# CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDATIONS:-

## CONCLUSION:-

- THIS PHISHING EMAIL AWARENESS ASSESSMENT ANALYZED THREE EMAIL SAMPLES USING GMAIL, GOOGLE ADMIN TOOLBOX MESSAGE HEADER ANALYZER, AND MXTOOLBOX EMAIL HEADER ANALYZER.
- THE ANALYSIS FOCUSED ON IDENTIFYING SUSPICIOUS INDICATORS, VALIDATING EMAIL AUTHENTICATION MECHANISMS, AND ASSESSING POTENTIAL PHISHING RISKS.
- ALL ANALYZED EMAILS SUCCESSFULLY PASSED SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC AUTHENTICATION CHECKS. HOWEVER, THE MESSAGES WERE DELIVERED TO THE SPAM FOLDER AND CONTAINED UNSOLICITED PROMOTIONAL OR ENGAGEMENT-BASED CONTENT.
- BASED ON THE ASSESSMENT, THE ANALYZED EMAILS WERE CLASSIFIED AS SUSPICIOUS EMAILS WITH MEDIUM RISK. NO DIRECT CREDENTIAL THEFT ATTEMPTS OR AUTHENTICATION FAILURES WERE IDENTIFIED DURING THE INVESTIGATION.

## **RECOMMENDATIONS:-**

- **VERIFY SENDER IDENTITIES BEFORE RESPONDING TO EMAILS.**
- **AVOID CLICKING UNKNOWN LINKS OR DOWNLOADING UNEXPECTED ATTACHMENTS.**
- **ENABLE MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA) ON IMPORTANT ACCOUNTS.**
- **REPORT SUSPICIOUS EMAILS TO THE SECURITY TEAM IMMEDIATELY.**
- **REGULARLY PARTICIPATE IN CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING.**
- **USE EMAIL FILTERING AND SPAM PROTECTION MECHANISMS TO REDUCE PHISHING EXPOSURE.**